

This playbook is your complete WhatsApp-first go-to-market strategy for Grit. Every tactic, message template, and milestone lives inside WhatsApp itself — no ads, no website, no app store. Just conversations that convert.

Target	Timeline	CAC Goal	Avg LTV
1,000 paying users	12 months	< \$5 USD	\$120 USD

All figures in USD. Pricing model: \$9.99/month Pro tier as primary offer.

1. Why WhatsApp-First Makes Sense

Most SaaS products fight for attention inside crowded app stores or social feeds. Grit's advantage is that the product IS the channel. Users get coached inside the same app they use to text their friends — no install, no login, no friction. That unlocks a marketing strategy most competitors can't copy.

Advantage	What It Means for Growth
No app download	Share link opens a chat — zero install drop-off. Typical app install rate from a link is 15-25%. WhatsApp chat open rate is 95%+.
Already trusted	WhatsApp is the world's #1 messaging app. Users don't fear clicking a wa.me link from a friend.
Share-native	The referral mechanic is built into the product. Users forward their personalised link the same way they share a meme.
Global reach	Works in Australia, UK, US, India, Nigeria — any WhatsApp market — with zero additional infrastructure.
Low cost to serve	One WhatsApp Business API account reaches millions. Meta charges per conversation (~\$0.05 AUD), not per message.
Organic proof	Coaching conversations appear in the same thread the user scrolls daily. Progress screenshots get shared naturally.

2. The WhatsApp Acquisition Funnel

AWARENESS

- Person sees a WhatsApp screenshot posted by a friend, influencer, or in a Facebook Group.
- Or they receive a personal referral message from an existing Grit user.
- Or they spot a short-form video (Reels/TikTok) where the coach is inside WhatsApp.

INTEREST

- They tap the wa.me link or scan the QR code.
- WhatsApp opens instantly — no app store, no email signup.
- Grit sends: 'Hi! I'm Grit — your personal accountability coach. What's your name?'

ONBOARDING (10 mins)

- 10 short questions establish goal, timeline, schedule, tone preference.
- Grit generates a personalised 90-day plan and sends it as a PDF.
- Trial starts — 7 days free (30 days if referred).

CONVERSION

- Daily check-ins build habit and emotional investment.
- On Day 5 (or Day 28 if referred), pricing menu is sent.
- One-tap reply selects tier — Stripe checkout link sent automatically.

REFERRAL

- After payment confirmed, user receives their unique share link.
- Prompted to share via WhatsApp to contacts, groups, or status.
- Every converted referral earns 20% recurring commission — paid monthly.

KEY INSIGHT

The entire funnel — awareness through payment — can complete in under 15 minutes. A referred friend taps a link at 8pm, completes onboarding, and receives their first check-in by 8am the next morning. No human sales touchpoint required.

3. Day-by-Day: 30-Day WhatsApp Launch Plan

This plan assumes you are starting from zero — no subscribers, no audience, no ad budget. All activities are free or use the built-in referral programme.

Days	Focus	Daily Actions	Target Outcome
1-3	Foundation	- Register WhatsApp Business number - Set display name to 'Grit' - Set profile photo & description - Create your personal referral link - Test the full onboarding flow yourself	System live. Your link works.
4-7	Warm Network	- Message 20 people you know personally - Send: 'Testing my new AI accountability coach — want to try it free for 7 days?' - Include your wa.me link - Follow up with anyone who doesn't reply	10-20 trial signups from warm contacts
8-14	Facebook Groups	- Find 5 active groups: fitness, finance, personal dev (AU-based) - Post genuine value (tip or insight) every 2 days - On Day 3 in each group, share your story + Grit link - Respond to every comment personally	20-40 new trial signups
15-21	Referral Engine	- Identify your most engaged trial users - Send: 'Reply SHARE and I'll send you your referral link + earn 20% every month' - Help them craft their own personal share message - Celebrate every referral publicly (with permission)	First 5-10 referral-generated users
22-28	Content Leverage	- Screenshot 3 real check-in conversations (anonymised or with consent) - Post to personal Facebook, Instagram Stories, LinkedIn - Caption: 'This is what accountability looks like in 2026' - Add wa.me link in bio and post caption	20-50 inbound link clicks
29-30	Review & Double Down	- Identify top 3 acquisition channels from analytics - Double outreach in winning channel - Personally message every user who didn't convert from trial - Offer 1-month extension for feedback call	50-100 total trialists, 15-30 paying

4. WhatsApp Message Templates (Copy-Paste Ready)

Use these exact templates. They are written the way people actually text — short, direct, no corporate language. Edit the [brackets] to personalise.

WARM OUTREACH (send to contacts you know)

Hey [name] - I just launched something and you're one of the first people I thought of.
It's an AI accountability coach on WhatsApp - no app to download, just texts you daily.
Free for 7 days. Tap this and it'll introduce itself:
[wa.me link]
Would love your honest feedback.

FACEBOOK GROUP POST

Anyone else find it impossible to stay consistent without someone checking in on you?
I've been building an AI coach that does exactly that - texts you daily on WhatsApp,
tracks your streaks, sends you a personalised plan.
Testing it free for the next 7 days if anyone wants to try it:
[wa.me link]
No app to download. Just opens a chat.

FOLLOW-UP TO NON-RESPONDER (send 3 days later)

Hey - just checking in. Did you get a chance to try Grit?
No worries if not - totally free to start. Only takes 10 minutes.
Here's the link again: [wa.me link]

REFERRAL PROMPT (send to active users)

Hey [name] - quick one.
If you know anyone who's been trying to stick to [fitness/finance/their goal] -
you can send them your personal link and they get 30 days free instead of 7.
And you earn 20% of whatever they pay, every month they stay.
Reply SHARE and I'll send your link now.

REFERRAL SHARE MESSAGE (user sends to their contacts)

Have you heard of Grit? It's an AI coach on WhatsApp - no app.
Checks in with you every day, tracks your goals, sends you a proper plan.
I've been using it and it actually works.
Use my link and you get 30 days free (instead of 7):
[their referral link]

INFLUENCER COLD OUTREACH (DM on Instagram)

Hey [name] - I follow your [fitness/finance] content and it's genuinely good.
I've built an AI accountability coach that lives inside WhatsApp.
Your audience is exactly who it's for - people who want to stay consistent but need a push.
Would you try it free and give me feedback? If you like it, I'd love to chat about
a partnership - you'd earn 20% recurring on every subscriber you refer.
No obligation. Let me know.

5. Influencer & Creator Strategy

Forget expensive macro-influencers. WhatsApp converts best when it feels personal. Target micro-creators (2K-50K followers) whose audiences have a specific goal — exactly what Grit solves.

Creator Tier	Followers	Approach	Commission	Expected Signups
Friends & Family	0	Personal ask — 'I built this, would you try it?'	None (goodwill)	5-20
Micro-Influencer	2K-20K	Free 30-day access + 20% recurring affiliate	20% recurring	20-100/month
Mid-Tier Creator	20K-200K	Free access + 20% recurring + rev share on first 100	20% + bonus	100-500/month
Niche Community Manager	500-5K group members	Exclusive group discount code + 20% recurring	20% recurring	10-50/month
Podcast Host	Any size	30-second promo + unique code + 20% commission	20% recurring	5-30/month

How to Find Micro-Creators (Free)

- Search Instagram hashtags: #australianfitness #moneygoals #personaldevelopment #gymlife
- Search TikTok: 'accountability challenge', 'goal tracker', '75 hard', 'money journey'
- Facebook Groups: search '[city] fitness', 'Australian personal finance', 'side hustle Australia'
- Reddit: r/fitness, r/personalfinance, r/ausfinance — look for top commenters with history
- LinkedIn: search 'accountability coach', 'productivity consultant' — DM with specific pitch

HIGHEST-LEVERAGE MOVE

The single best creator partnership: find a fitness or finance creator who posts daily habits content. They share their Grit referral link once in Stories. Their audience trusts them. The link opens WhatsApp instantly. Even a 1% conversion on 10K views = 100 trials.

6. WhatsApp Status Strategy (Organic Reach)

WhatsApp Status (like Stories) shows to all your contacts. Post to your personal number's Status daily during launch. It's the most underrated free channel for WhatsApp-native products.

Day	Status Content	Call-to-Action
Mon	Screenshot of a Grit check-in conversation (anonymised)	Reply to this status to try it free
Tue	Stat graphic: 'People who track daily are 3x more likely to hit their goals'	Link in reply — tap to start
Wed	Testimonial quote from a trial user (with permission)	DM me and I'll send you their link
Thu	Your own streak counter — 'Day 14 streak with Grit'	Ask how — reply to this status
Fri	Before/after of a week's check-ins showing progress summary	Tap to try free for 7 days
Sat	Motivational graphic relevant to your niche	No hard sell — brand awareness
Sun	Weekly results post — how many people started this week	Tap the link and join them

QR Code Placement

- Print a QR code that opens your wa.me link and stick it anywhere people stand still: gym noticeboard, cafe counter, coworking space, physiotherapy waiting room.
- Add the QR code to your email signature with the line: 'Trying to hit a goal? Tap this.'
- Create a simple Canva graphic with the QR code for Instagram bio, Facebook cover photo, and LinkedIn banner.
- If you do any public speaking, workshops, or group fitness classes — put the QR on the first slide.

7. The Built-In Referral Engine

The referral programme is the most scalable part of Grit's growth strategy. Unlike traditional affiliate programmes, Grit's referrals happen inside WhatsApp — the most trusted channel for personal recommendations.

Step 1: User types SHARE	Grit sends their unique link: wa.me/61XXXXXXXXXX?text=START+BRETT-X7K2
Step 2: User sends to contacts	Pre-written message included. One tap to forward in WhatsApp.
Step 3: Friend taps link	WhatsApp opens. Chat starts. 30-day free trial activated automatically.
Step 4: Friend subscribes	Stripe webhook fires. 20% commission calculated and added to referrer wallet.
Step 5: Monthly payout	1st of every month: referrer receives WhatsApp message with earnings + bank transfer.

Commission rate	20% of monthly subscription
Referred user trial	30 days free (vs 7 days standard)
Referred user discount	20% off first paid month
Referrer earns per \$9.99 sub	\$2.00/month recurring
Referrer with 10 active referrals	\$20/month passive income
Referrer with 50 active referrals	\$100/month passive income
Platform cost of programme	20% margin reduction — offset by near-zero CAC

8. Realistic Growth Projections

Three scenarios modelled on WhatsApp-native products with similar referral mechanics. Conservative assumes manual outreach only. Base includes 5 micro-influencer partnerships. Optimistic assumes 2 mid-tier creator partnerships in Month 4+.

Month	Conservative (paid users)	Base Case (paid users)	Optimistic (paid users)	Base MRR (USD)
1	10	20	30	\$200
2	25	50	80	\$500
3	45	100	180	\$1,000
4	70	170	350	\$1,700
5	100	260	550	\$2,600
6	135	380	800	\$3,800
7	175	510	1,050	\$5,100
8	220	650	1,300	\$6,500
9	270	800	1,550	\$8,000
10	325	960	1,800	\$9,600
11	385	1,120	2,050	\$11,200
12	450	1,300	2,300	\$13,000

Base case assumptions: 30% trial-to-paid conversion, 5% monthly churn, each paying user refers 0.3 additional users on average. Creator partnerships add ~100 trials/month from Month 3.

\$5K/MONTH MILESTONE

Month 7 base case: 510 paying users x \$9.99 = \$5,100 MRR. Gross margin ~78% after Stripe fees, Meta API costs, Railway hosting, and referral commissions. Net profit at this scale: approximately \$3,900/month USD.

What Drives the Difference Between Scenarios

Driver	Conservative	Base	Optimistic
Referral rate (referrals per user)	0.1	0.3	0.6
Creator partnerships	0	5 micro	2 mid-tier
Trial conversion rate	20%	30%	35%
Monthly churn rate	8%	5%	3%
Outreach per week (manual)	10 messages	30 messages	50 messages

9. Content That Drives WhatsApp Signups

You don't need a massive following. You need content that makes people immediately want to tap a link. Here's what works for WhatsApp-native products.

SCREENSHOT POSTS	HIGH	Post a real conversation between a user and Grit (anonymised). Show the check-in question and an honest reply. Show the streak counter. People see themselves in it — and they tap the link.
BEFORE/AFTER BEHAVIOUR	HIGH	'Before Grit: skipped gym 4 times this week. After Grit: Day 23 streak.' No transformation photos needed. Behaviour change is the proof.
FAIL POSTS	MEDIUM	Share when a user missed a day and Grit's response. Real, human, encouraging. This builds trust — people know it won't judge them.
STAT GRAPHICS	MEDIUM	'People who track daily are 42% more likely to achieve their goal.' One fact. One visual. Link in comments. Run this as a boosted post for \$5/day.
SHORT REELS/TIKTOKS	VERY HIGH	Screen-record a 30-second WhatsApp conversation with Grit. No voiceover needed. Just the chat. Caption: 'My AI accountability coach just said this.' These go viral in fitness and finance niches.
TESTIMONIALS	HIGH	After Week 1, message every active trial user: 'How's it going? Mind if I share your words?' Post exact quotes. Real people. Real goals. Infinitely more powerful than any ad copy.

10. Weekly Operating Rhythm (Founder-Led Phase)

Until you hit 200 paying users, growth is founder-led. This is the exact weekly routine that compounds fastest.

Day	Time	Activity	Tool
Monday	30 min	Review last week's trial signups. Message anyone who didn't complete onboarding.	WhatsApp
Monday	15 min	Post weekly stat or insight to Facebook Groups (3-5 groups)	Facebook
Tuesday	20 min	Cold DM 10 micro-influencers with personalised pitch	Instagram/TikTok DMs
Wednesday	20 min	Post screenshot or testimonial to personal social accounts	Instagram/LinkedIn
Wednesday	15 min	Message 5 current trial users: 'How's it going? Anything I can improve?'	WhatsApp
Thursday	20 min	Follow up with influencers who didn't reply. Engage with their content first.	Instagram
Friday	15 min	Post WhatsApp Status content for the weekend	WhatsApp Status
Friday	20 min	Send SHARE prompt to users who've been active 5+ days	WhatsApp
Sunday	30 min	Review weekly numbers: signups, trials, conversions, referrals, churn	Railway analytics / DB
Sunday	15 min	Plan next week's outreach list and content	Notes app

TIME COMMITMENT

Total weekly time commitment: approximately 3 hours. This is the minimum viable founder-led growth effort. As revenue grows, reinvest 20% back into paid acquisition (boosted posts or influencer fees) to remove the manual ceiling.

11. What NOT to Do (WhatsApp Marketing Mistakes)

Spamming broadcast lists	AVOID	Sending unsolicited WhatsApp messages to people who haven't opted in violates Meta's policy and will get your Business Account banned. Only send to people who've messaged you first.
Buying follower lists	AVOID	Fake followers don't tap links. Real micro-communities of 500 engaged people outperform 50,000 bot followers every time for WhatsApp conversions.
Posting the same message everywhere	AVOID	Facebook Group admins will remove you. Personalise every outreach. Reference something specific about the group or the person's content.
Spending on ads before proving conversion	RISK	Don't run paid ads until you have evidence that 25%+ of trial users convert to paid. Prove the funnel manually first, then scale with budget.
Ignoring trial users who go quiet	RISK	A user who completes onboarding but stops responding is your most recoverable churning. A personal message from the founder ('everything okay?') has a 30-40% reactivation rate.
Setting it and forgetting it	RISK	In the first 6 months, no automation replaces founder involvement. Read every check-in reply, respond to every support message, fix every friction point personally.

12. Key Metrics to Track Weekly

Metric	How to Measure	Healthy Target	Red Flag
Trial signups/week	New users in DB with onboarding_complete=True	> 20 by Month 2	< 5/week for 3 weeks
Trial-to-paid rate	(paying / completed trials) x 100	> 25%	< 15%
Day 7 retention	Users still active after 7 days of trial	> 60%	< 40%
Referral rate	Referrals generated / paying users	> 0.3 per user	< 0.1 after Month 2
Monthly churn	(cancelled this month / active start of month)	< 5%	> 10%
WhatsApp reply rate	% of check-in messages that get a reply	> 50%	< 25%
Avg streak length	Average current_streak across active users	> 10 days	< 4 days
MRR growth rate	(this month MRR - last month) / last month	> 20%/month	< 10%/month

Your Most Important Number

Until Month 6, the only metric that truly matters is **trial-to-paid conversion rate**. Everything else — CAC, MRR, churn — is secondary until you know that people who try Grit are willing to pay for it. Hit 25%+ conversion before scaling any acquisition spend.